



StartUp Checklist





Phase 1: Planning and Research

- ☐ **Validate the idea:** Interview potential customers to ensure market demand.
- ☐ **Analyze competitors:** Identify gaps in current market offerings.
- ☐ **Write a business plan:** Outline your value proposition, financial projections, and marketing strategy.



Phase 2: Legal and Structure

- ☐ **Choose a business structure:** Select an entity type like an LLC, Corporation, or Sole Proprietorship.
- ☐ **Register your business name:** Secure your legal name with your state and check trademark availability.
- ☐ **Apply for an EIN:** Get a Federal Employer Identification Number from the IRS for tax purposes.
- ☐ **Obtain licenses and permits.**



Phase 3: Financial Setup

- ☐ **Open a business bank account:** Keep personal and business finances strictly separated.
- ☐ **Set up accounting software:** Track income, expenses, and future tax obligations from day one.
- ☐ **Secure funding:** Arrange startup capital through personal savings, loans, or investors.



Phase 4: Brand and Digital Infrastructure

- ☐ **Secure your domain:** Purchase your website URL and match social media handles.
- ☐ **Build a website:** Create a simple, clean site explaining your services and contact info.
- ☐ **Design a logo:** Establish your basic visual brand identity and color scheme.



Phase 5: Launch Readiness

- ☐ **Set up core tools:** Implement email hosting, customer relationship management (CRM) software, and project trackers.
- ☐ **Establish vendor relationships:** Finalize contracts with suppliers, manufacturers, or software providers.
- ☐ **Plan marketing launch:** Prepare your initial social media posts, email outreach, or local advertising campaigns.